PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE –

Notice of Intent to Sole Source

1. **SOLICITATION NUMBER: 75N98026Q00194**

2. **TITLE:** Annual Service and Maintenance Agreement for Thermo Electron Q-Exactive HF-X Mass Spectrometer and Components

3. **RESPONSE DATE:** April 20, 2026, at 9:00 am EDT.

4. **PRIMARY POINT OF CONTACT:**

   Nicholas Capobianco

   nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov

I. INTRODUCTION:

THIS IS A PRE-SOLICITATION NON-COMPETITIVE (NOTICE OF INTENT) SYNOPSIS TO AWARD A CONTRACT WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME).

The National Center for Advancing Translational Sciences (NCATS), Division of Pre-Clinical Innovation (DPI), Drug Metabolism and Pharmacokinetics (DMPK) requires a service and maintenance agreement to support a Thermo Electron Q-Exactive HF-X mass spectrometer and associated Vanquish system components.
This instrument is critical to supporting ongoing research evaluating drug candidate absorption, distribution, metabolism, and excretion (ADME) properties. Continuous operation and reliability of this system are essential to maintaining scientific productivity and supporting internal and external collaborations.

II. NORTH AMERICAN INDUSTRY CLASSIFICATION SYSTEM (NAICS) CODE and SET ASIDE STATUS

NAICS Code: 811210 – Electronic and Precision Equipment Repair and Maintenance
Size Standard: $34 Million. This acquisition is not set aside for small business.

III. REGULATORY AUTHORITY

The resultant contract will include all applicable provisions and clauses in effect through the Federal Acquisition Circular (FAC) 2024-07 dated 08-29-2024.
This acquisition is conducted in accordance with FAR Part 13—Simplified Acquisition Procedures and FAR Part 12—Acquisition of Commercial Products and Commercial Services.

IV. STATUTORY AUTHORITY

This acquisition is for a commercial item or service and is conducted under the authority of the FAR Subpart 13.5—Simplified Procedures for Certain Commercial Items and the statutory authority of This acquisition is conducted under the authority of FAR 13.106-1(b)(1) – Soliciting from a Single Source, as only one source is reasonably available to meet the Government's requirement.

V. DESCRIPTION OF REQUIREMENT:

A. PURPOSE AND OBJECTIVES:

Purchase Description:

The Government requires a **Thermo Electron Unity Essential Support Plan (brand-name)** for the following equipment:

- Q Exactive HF-X Mass Spectrometer
- Vanquish Binary Pump H
- Vanquish Split Sampler HT
- Vanquish Column Compartment

The service agreement shall include:

- One (1) annual preventive maintenance visit
- Corrective maintenance services (labor, parts, and travel included)
- Technical support with rapid response times
- Software and firmware updates
- Access to OEM knowledge base resources

Salient characteristics:

The required service must meet the following minimum characteristics:

- Must be performed by OEM-certified Thermo Electron Field Service Engineers
- Must include access to proprietary diagnostic software and firmware
- Must include OEM-certified replacement parts
- Must support manufacturer-required calibration and tuning procedures
- Must provide software and firmware updates
- Must ensure system performance meets manufacturer specifications

PERIOD OF PERFORMANCE:

Base year 4/23/2026-4/22/2027

Option year 1 4/23/2027-4/22/2028

Option year 2 4/23/2028-4/22/2029

VI. CONTRACTING WITHOUT PROVIDING FOR FULL OR OPEN COMPETITION (INCLUDING BRAND-NAME) DETERMINATION

The determination by the Government to award a contract without providing for full and open competition is based upon the market research conducted. Specifically, Thermo Electron North America LLC is the only vendor in the marketplace that can provide the services required by NCATS. The equipment is proprietary to its manufacturer and this company is the sole provider of maintenance for this equipment.

In accordance with FAR part 10, extensive market research was conducted to reach this determination. Additionally, contacts with knowledgeable individuals both in industry and Government, as well as reviews of available product literature, revealed no other sources. Finally, a review of the GSA Advantage, Dynamic Small Business Search, and previous government acquisitions returned no results that meet all of the requirements. Therefore, only Thermo Electron North America LLC is capable of meeting the needs of this requirement.

The intended source is:

Thermo Electron North America LLC
1400 Northpoint Pkwy Suite 10
West Palm Beach, FL 33407-1976

VII. CLOSING STATEMENT

THIS SYNOPSIS IS NOT A REQUEST FOR COMPETITIVE PROPOSALS. However, interested parties may identify their interest and capability to respond to this notice.

A determination by the Government not to compete this proposed contract based upon responses to this notice is solely within the discretion of the Government. All responsible sources may submit a capability statement, proposal, or quotation which shall be considered by the agency. The information received will normally be considered solely for the purposes of determining whether to proceed on a non-competitive basis or to conduct a competitive procurement. This notice does not obligate the Government to award a contract or otherwise pay for the information provided in response.

Responses to this notice shall contain sufficient information to establish the interested parties' bona-fide capabilities for fulfilling the requirement and include: unit price, list price, shipping and handling costs, the delivery period after contract award, the prompt payment discount terms, the F.O.B. Point (Destination or Origin), the Dun & Bradstreet Number (DUNS), the Taxpayer Identification Number (TIN), and the certification of business size. All offerors must have an active registration in the System for Award Management (SAM) www.sam.gov.

All responses must be received by the closing date and time of this announcement and must reference the solicitation number, **75N98026Q00194**. Responses must be submitted electronically to Nicholas Capobianco, Contract Specialist at Nicholas.capobianco@nih.gov.